
AS/A2 Progression and performance assessments

Students undertaking Unit 4 will now specialise in a single performance role. This will by the nature of an advanced coursework unit allow them to evolve as more knowledgeable and able participants and contributors to a single physical activity. It is envisaged that students will therefore begin the GCE Advanced course in September one band below that awarded for the Advanced Subsidiary course.

For example, an AS student awarded 14 out of 15 at Advanced Subsidiary level would have been placed in the band 13–15. At the commencement of the A2 course they would be placed, albeit provisionally, in the mark band 13–16.

Centres need to take into account when making their initial assessment of students any specific attainments achieved during the end of the Advanced Subsidiary course and the commencement of the GCE Advanced course. These may include, for example, gaining a governing body qualification or the completion of a summer-based sport such as athletics.

Over the life span of Unit 4 students will seek opportunities to further develop their chosen role and thereby potentially gain a higher-band award, thus showing said progression from the final AS to the final A2 mark in four key areas:

- increased physiological status — maturation
- increased psychological expertise
- increased technical and tactical proficiency
- increased knowledge and understanding of the sphere of performing in their activity.

What students need to do

4.1 Development Plan

Introduction

This task requires students to select **one** of the roles undertaken for *Task 2.1: Personal Performance* in Unit 2 and plan, research, perform, record, review and evaluate a related development plan.

Planning and research will form component one. Recording and reviewing will form component two, and the review and evaluation will form component three, as reflected in the mark scheme. The development plan will require the applied use of the appropriate knowledge and understanding related to a specific area, designed to further develop the student's performance in their chosen role.

The development plan is required to be undertaken over an appropriate period, but not less than eight weeks, and evidenced with an evaluation of the outcomes achieved. Students may include testimonial evidence, video and photographic evidence and log details in order to validate the plan.

Player/participant

Students will have the option to focus their development plan on specifically improving their performance in one performance area, or role.

The development plan may cover physiological weaknesses or technical developments such as specific techniques for a physical activity — for example, working to eradicate a weak backhand in a racket sport or to refine a technique such as a bowling action in cricket or throwing-in at line-outs in rugby.

This task must be personal to the individual and not undertaken as a group session.